

9.1 Future Mobile Entertainment Scenarios

Here's an MEF White Paper on "Future Mobile Entertainment Scenarios": Research carried out by Booz, Allen and Hamilton; written and edited by Mobile Entertainment Analyst.

The term "mobile entertainment" refers to entertainment products that run on wirelessly networked, portable, personal devices. "Mobile entertainment" is a general term that encapsulates products like downloadable mobile phone games, images and ring tones, as well as MP3 players and radio receivers built into mobile handsets. The term excludes mobile communications like person-to-person SMS and voicemail, as well as mobile commerce applications like auctions or ticket purchasing.

An Introduction to Mobile Entertainment

Mobile phones with colour screens, data connections, FM radios, MP3 players, MPEG4 video players, digital cameras and entertainment content are now widely available across the northern hemisphere. More than 200 companies—from giants like Nokia, Vodafone and Microsoft to startups like Digital Bridges, Cash-U and PacketVideo—are vying for leadership in this emerging industry. To understand the ways in which mobile entertainment affects people's lives, let's follow one consumer, Jen Hanks, age 24, as she accesses and uses three mobile entertainment products. In the back of a cab, after the final encore of a two-hour Coldplay show, Jen is still singing the band's song "Clocks." She grabs her phone, scrolls through the ringtone application that she downloaded two months ago, finds the Coldplay section and downloads the tune. Behind the scenes, Jen's ringtone client application on her handset communicates with the ringtone server via the wireless network. The server debits Jen's pre-paid account and streams the song data back to her handset so she can set it as her default ringer. Jen is in good company as she grabs her new ringtone. In 2002, artists were paid more than \$71 million in ringtone royalties, which suggests that the estimated revenues for ringtone sales were between \$710 million and \$1 billion.